Tone of voice and vocabulary

Argyll

Understanding who we're talking to – our four key personas

We should always write with our customers in mind.

Before writing any communications, think about our four personas. Each of them have different motivations, attitudes, needs and preferences. So it's important to consider these when crafting our copy.

The Private Professional

These customers need quiet, enclosed spaces, especially for client meetings and private calls.

Dial up language that reflects the historical nature of office building locations, shows more traditional ways of working, that shows the calm, private, discrete nature of our office design.

The Dynamic Executive

These customers prefer a mix of formal meeting spaces to impress visitors, enclosed spaces, for private calls, and multipurpose more social and informal working areas.

Dial up the iconic and impressive nature of office locations and architecture, show how interiors provide a smart mix of formal, to provide, to social spaces, and illustrate the 'wow factor' and exclusive access that visitors will feel.

The Hybrid Consultant

These customers need a broad range of working spaces to cover focused work, to open collaboration and areas for clients and visitors to work in.

Dial up how Argyll perfectly balances architecturally impressive and stylish office buildings, with progressive ways of working – collaborative focused, and flexible; and reflect contemporary office culture e.g. how the office facilitates remote work.

The Creative Entrepreneur

These customers tend to favour a range of informal, collaborative spaces, and a calmer space for more focused work.

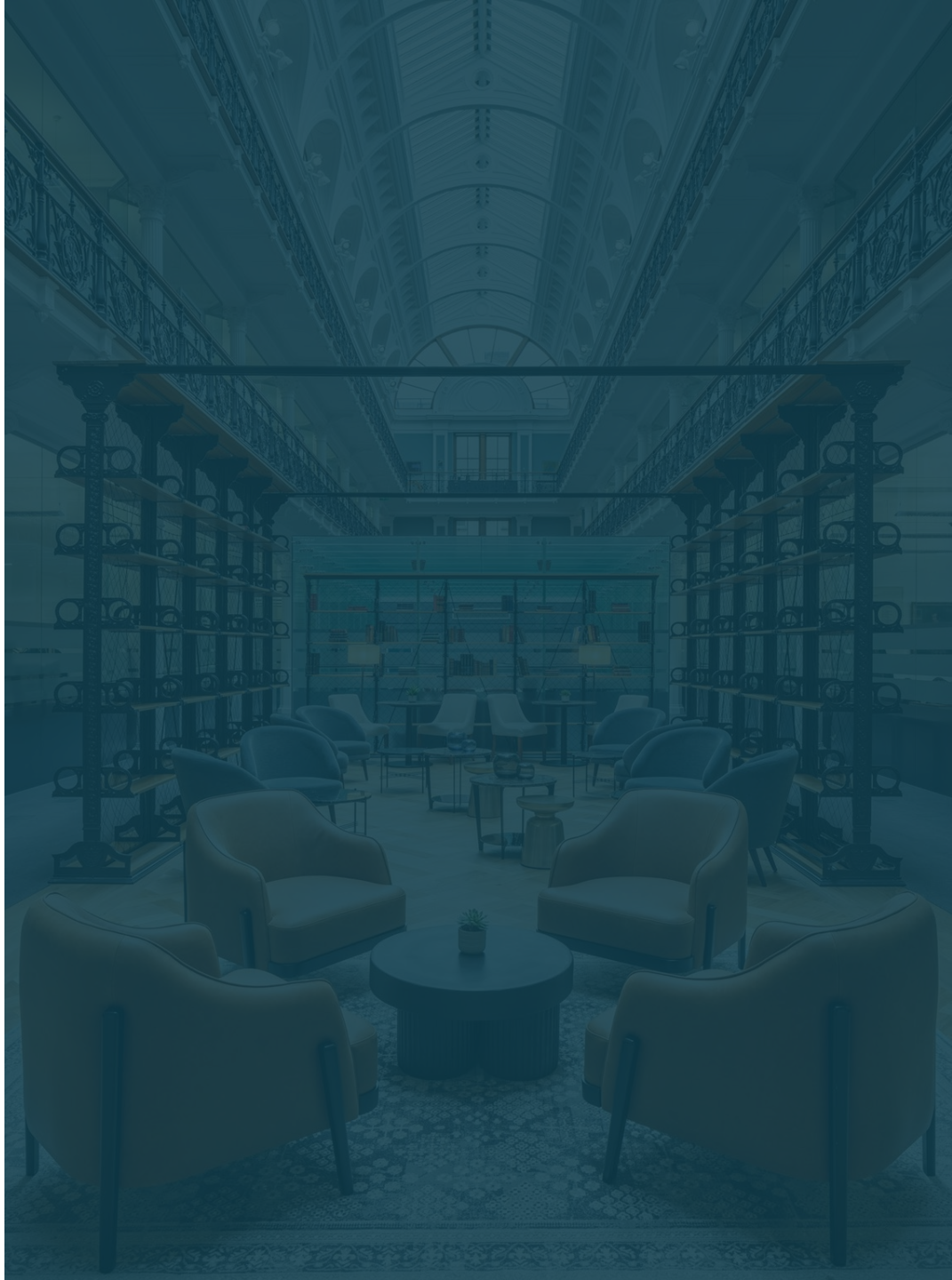
Dial up any unique, interesting and stand out aspects of office building design and architecture, show how the office reflects an open, stimulating, energetic environment.

Our tone of voice

We offer prestigious London addresses, impeccable service, and an elevated office experience for businesses whose reputation demands the best. What we say and how we say it helps us reinforce this brand positioning. (Or, undermine it if we get it wrong.)

Our voice reflects our character: **quietly confident, understated** and **warm** – expressing the calm assurance that our experienced team embodies.

These practical tips and techniques will help make sure all our writing carries the voice of Argyll.



Our writing style

- Avoid writing about Argyll in the third person. Instead, choose the first person: ‘we’ and ‘our’, instead of ‘Argyll has announced their…’.

- Address readers directly in the second person: ‘you,’ ‘your team’ and ‘your business’, to engage them in the content.
  - Rather than ‘we support businesses as they carry out their innovative work’, use ‘we’ll support you so you can…’
  - Rather than ‘businesses seek to…’, use ‘if you're looking for…’

- Our language should feel natural, relaxed and human - but not colloquial. Avoid language that you wouldn't use in natural conversation.
  - Rather than ‘It is unpleasant to arrive at the office flustered and sweaty…’ use ‘No one likes to arrive at the office flustered and sweaty….’
  - Rather than ‘we provide you with the support and technology to attain the very best results’ use ‘we’ll support you and your team to work at your best’.
  - Rather than ‘By conversing with potential clients in…’, use ‘Meet potential clients in…’

- Avoid language used by more ordinary/everyday office brands, e.g. ‘facilities’ or ‘solution’.
  - Rather than ‘Argyll has many facilities in place to help you create a positive work environment …’, use ‘Our offices are designed to help you create a positive work environment.’

- We are a premium office brand, so consider the way we describe our products and services.
  - Rather than ‘We have a range of offices…’, choose ‘Our collection of offices…’
  - Rather than ‘We are committed to delivering only the top quality services,’ choose ‘We are committed to delivering exceptional service’
  - Rather than ‘ our top quality staff’, choose ‘our experienced and attentive team.’

- Now ‘post-Covid’, we should avoid language that still refers to this, e.g. ‘for your team to return together safely,’ ‘lockdowns’ and ‘uncertainty’, as this feels dated already. But we should talk positively about the new way to work, e.g. ‘bringing your team together’, ‘or ‘making your time together really count’.

- Consider that Argyll’s customers are not your average businesses. These are successful, ambitious metro-affluents who seek better than the average office space. Avoid using basic business language, e.g. ‘can take a large portion of money out of your funds’, and avoid patronising them with things they likely already know, e.g. ‘Your office is an extension of your brand’.

Style tips

- Don’t use ampersands in body copy, unless a headline space restriction requires it
- Use sentence case not title case, e.g., 'Employee retention’ not ‘Employee Retention’.
- Use contractions where it feels natural, e.g., ‘It’s’ rather than ‘It is’, which can sound too formal
- We don’t capitalise the product names, so London Office Space should have lower case o and s – London office space
- Be sure to hyphenate correctly and consistently, e.g., ‘ready-to-use’, ‘on-demand’ ‘face-to-face’, ‘short-term’.

How to talk about Argyll's USPs

Location prestige

Premium postcodes that infer success, stability and confidence

Building character

Heritage properties with architectural history and warmth, provides a so-called wow factor for visitors, and creates a positive mood for employees

High stability

Consistency and stability projects resilience, and builds confidence, trust, familiarity and loyalty

Personal service

Personal service that combines a friendly, approachable style, with a highly professional and proactive attitude to meeting clients needs and addressing issues

Unbranded

Makes clients feel a greater sense of connection to the building, meets a range of needs for discretion, and creates a "grown-up" feel versus competitors with 'heavy branding'

How to talk about Argyll's USPs

Location prestige

Our locations and postcodes say a lot about us. They project style, substance and taste without having to point it out.

Our customers appreciate that our prestigious locations are a shorthand for success, confidence and reputation.

How we talk about our locations in writing

- Prestigious London addresses for businesses whose reputation demands the best.
- Sophisticated offices in London's finest locations.
- Addresses that speak for themselves.
- London's finest postcodes.
- Iconic locations that speak volumes.
- London's most prestigious neighbourhoods.
- Statement offices with the most prestigious addresses in London – from Mayfair to the City and beyond.
- Set within London's most prestigious postcodes.
- A choice of prestigious London addresses that reflect your business' identity.
- Inspiring lounges in some of London's most iconic neighbourhoods.
- Argyll's collection of distinctive office, meeting and event spaces are in London's most prestigious locations.

In conversation…

- Many businesses choose our locations because its prestigious address or postcode reflects their business' identity.
- We know how important your business' reputation is, which is why we've chosen properties in London's most prestigious neighbourhoods.
- We know how much first impressions count, so our collection of properties give you a choice of iconic London addresses.
- We have locations in Mayfair, the City, St. James's and in all London's most iconic neighbourhoods, so you can choose the area and property that feels right for your business.

How to talk about Argyll's USPs

Building character

Our customers appreciate the heritage charm and distinct architectural style of our properties. They choose our offices because they are distinctive and impress – projecting an enviable and desirable status, and offering a sense of solidity, warmth and class. The unique mood of each building is important, as is our elevated office experience.

How we talk about our buildings' character and style in writing

- A sophisticated place to work, collaborate, meet and host events.
- An elevated office experience for businesses whose reputation demands the best.
- A curated collection of distinctive London offices.
- Distinctive London offices for discerning businesses.
- Discreet, heritage-rich offices.
- Calm, private offices with character.
- A contemporary office space with heritage flair.
- Our sophisticated workspaces provide a stylish backdrop for your business.
- Impressive offices with distinctive architecture, designed to make a lasting impression.
- Smart, flexible office environments that support the way you work and collaborate.
- A collection of unique, distinctive office spaces that inspire.
- Architecturally-interesting buildings.
- Timeless interiors.

In conversation…

- We select our properties because of their architectural interest or heritage charm. Inside, they all have timeless and sophisticated interiors.
- Each of our properties is distinctive in its own unique way, with its own feel, atmosphere and mood. So it's not just the address your choosing, you're choosing the office that feels right for your business and the way you like to work.
- While all of our properties are unique, we've designed them to have the same sophisticated style, high design standards, and thoughtful details.
- We know how important first impressions are when you're hosting clients and guests for meetings or events, so we design all our interiors to make a real impact.

How to talk about Argyll's USPs

Personal service

Our customers appreciate the attentive and highly professional approach of our on-site teams. Where possible, describe *how* our personal and proactive service plays out in reality, and what that experience means for customers, not just saying we offer excellent service.

How we talk about our personal service in writing

- Impeccable service for businesses whose reputation demands the best.
- We give discerning businesses the support of truly personal service.
- Sophisticated offices with exceptional service in London's finest locations, for businesses built on reputation.
- Thoughtful service, iconic locations and distinctive spaces.
- A team that quietly delivers on all the details.
- Our sophisticated workspaces provide a stylish backdrop for your business, while our quietly exceptional service supports your team.
- We're here to make sure everything works effortlessly, and reflects the high standards you set for your own business.
- Considerate service that puts you, and your guests, at ease.
- Where discretion and privacy comes as standard.
- Thoughtful service from a team that feels like an extension of your business.
- Quietly exceptional service from our on-site teams who are always there to elevate your working day.

In conversation…

- We have experienced on-site teams in all our properties, so there's always someone to support you.
- Our team are very attentive – they get to know you and your business so they can anticipate what you need.
- We know first impressions count, so we take great pride in welcoming and putting your guests as ease. We see ourselves as an extension of your team.
- We get to know how you and your team like to work, and support you in making your days run smoothly.
- Our team is highly-professional, so if privacy and discretion is important to you and your guests, you can have confidence that they'll always deliver that.
- We take great pride in remembering the details, like how you like to be greeted each day, or the way you like a room set up, or your regular visitors' names.
- Because our team are so attentive and efficient, you'll find everything just works. They've thought of and sorted things before you even realise you need them.

How to talk about Argyll's USPs

Unbranded

Our customers appreciate that our absence of branding makes the building feel more like it's theirs – or collectively 'ours'. They like the subtle sensitivity of this and that it avoids the potential stigma of more mainstream 'rented offices'. Our properties become a characterful backdrop on which they can project their business.

How we talk about our unbranded spaces in writing

- We don't impose our brand. We create spaces that feel like yours – designed to embody your style, your ambition, and your reputation.
- We never brand our office spaces, so yours is always the focus.
- Our properties are always unbranded to ensure you feel a sense of ownership.
- Each unbranded environment is designed to reflect how businesses see themselves, and how they want to be seen.
- We never impose our brand on your business – our spaces are always unbranded.
- The canvas of a refined, unbranded office.

In conversation…

- None of our spaces are branded as Argyll – we want our properties to feel like yours.
- We don't brand our spaces, so your business and your brand are the focus.
- Because we don't brand our properties with Argyll, it means the space becomes a blank canvas for you and your business.
- It's important to us that you feel like the space is yours, and that we have collective ownership – it's one of the reasons we never visibly brand our properties as Argyll.

How to talk about Argyll's USPs

High stability

Our customers appreciate that we are an established and experienced brand, reliably providing elevated offices and workspace for more than 25 years. We want them to feel confident in the consistency of our brand experience – regardless of which property or product they use.

How we talk about our high stability in writing

- Thoughtful service, iconic locations and distinctive spaces – these three foundations have shaped our office experience for over 25 years.
- We create sophisticated work environments with consistently high standards.
- We choose and cherish distinctive properties that leave a lasting impression on our customers, and a lasting legacy for our capital.
- All our properties are unique and distinct – what remains consistent is our impeccable service, understated style and sophisticated office experience.
- Whichever property you choose, you'll experience the same discretion, privacy and personal service.
- We want you to feel a sense of ownership of your office space, so we'll always keep you informed about our programme of small, regular improvements.

In conversation…

- We've been creating these exceptional London offices for more than 25 years.
- We feel a great responsibility to these beautiful properties, and want to develop and care for them so we leave a lasting legacy for the capital.
- Our on-site teams are highly experienced and understand how to deliver a personal service consistently.
- All our properties are distinctive and different, but when you step inside, you'll know it's an Argyll space.
- It's important to us that you feel a sense of ownership of your office space, so we'll always keep you informed about our programme of small, regular improvements.

Our vocabulary

The words we use can help us reinforce our brand positioning: offering distinctive London offices for discerning businesses

It's important that we all use the same language and phrases to describe our product and services, so that we sound like a unified team and our brand communicates consistently.

We say	We don't say
Argyll	~~The Argyll Club / Argyll Club~~
Private offices	~~Serviced offices [except for SEO]~~
Buildings / Locations / Properties	~~Sites / Clubs / Centres~~
Lounge / Business lounge	~~Club lounge / Executive lounge~~
Customers / Clients	~~Members~~
Office customers / clients	~~Residential clients~~
Coworking	~~Portfolio membership / Coworking & lounge~~
The business / The company	~~The Club~~
Our people / Team	~~Employees / Staff~~
Colleague / Team member	~~Person / Staff member~~
Our collection of buildings	~~Network~~
Exceptional / Impeccable / Thoughtful service	~~5* service~~
Operations / Operations team	~~Customer Services / Customer Service team~~
Central Support team	~~Head Office~~

Adjectives

Our voice is quietly confident, understated and warm, so we shouldn't overuse adjectives. But when we do use them, we need to use the right language.

Here are some words we do and don't use when describing our buildings, products and services.

We do use…
Sophisticated
Prestigious
Elegant
Exceptional
Impeccable
Distinctive
Stylish
Thoughtful
Refined
Discreet
Private
Considered
Timeless
Iconic
Heritage-rich
Contemporary
Elevated

We don't use…
~~Premium~~
~~Luxury / luxurious~~
~~Modern~~
~~Undeniable wow factor~~
~~Distinguished~~
~~Elite~~
~~Incredible~~
~~Stunning~~
~~Traditional~~
~~Fashionable~~
~~Friendly/chatty~~
~~Intimate~~
~~Bold~~
~~Ultimate~~
~~Homely~~
~~Exquisite~~
~~Chic~~